GIANNA C. D'APOLITO

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EDUCATION

August 2023 – May 2027 (Expected) | *Arizona State University* | **Population Health PhD**
Health Equity Track
August 2019 - August 2020 | *University of Pittsburgh* | **Master's in Biomedical Sciences**
August 2015- May 2019 | *Ohio State University* | **Bachelor of Science in Neuroscience,**
Specialization: Behavioral/ Systems

OTHER TRAINING

2026 | Global Certificate in Legal Epidemiology - Temple University
2022 | Lean Six Sigma Quality Improvement White Belt and Green Belt with JASP
2022 | Results-Based Accountability
2020-2021 | DataCamp Certificates: Data Visualizations; Tableau; SQL; Python; R

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Arizona State University College of Health Solutions | **PhD Candidate** | August 2023 - present
- Dissertation: "Newborn Screening Declination: Policies, Programs, and Parents"
- Chair: Dr. Niko Verdecias-Pellum

Harvard Pilgrim Health Care Institute, Department of Population Medicine, *Division of Child Health Research and Policy (CHeRP)* | **Research Fellow** | September 2026 – present

Association of Public Health Laboratory-Centers for Disease Control and Prevention | **Genomic Data Intern** | October 2024 - present

Arizona State University College of Health Solutions | **Graduate Research Associate** | August 2023 - present

Ohio State University Neural Stem Cell, Multiple Sclerosis (MS) Laboratory - Clinical research lab | **Research Assistant** | August 2016-May 2019

Ohio State University Behavioral Endocrinology and Postpartum Depression Laboratory | **Research Assistant** | September 2016-May 2017

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

PUBLISHED

1. **D'Apolito G,** Verdecias-Pellum N. Structural readiness of CBOs to address health-related social needs in chronic disease management programs. BMC Health Serv Res. 2026 Jun 25. doi: 10.1186/s12913-026-15017-9. PMID: 42351111.
2. Verdecias-Pellum, N., **D'Apolito, G**., Lohr, A. M., Rascón, A. M., & Palmer, K. N. B. (2026). Expanding Diabetes Self-Management Education to Address Health-Related Social Needs: A Qualitative Feasibility Study. International journal of environmental research and public health, 23(1), 88. https://doi.org/10.3390/ijerph23010088

UNDER REVIEW

1. Thomas, N.; Hita, D.; **D'Apolito, G.;** Smith J.; Koch, B.; Zhang, X.; Lemon, T.; Yudell, M.; Biviji, R. State Laws for Perinatal Mental Health Screening and Patient Education Varied Widely in the United States: A Scientific Legal Mapping Study, 2017-2018. *Under Review at Translational Behavioral Medicine.*

IN PREPARATION

1. **D'Apolito, G**; Carter, S; Lin, C; Matteson, J; Wu, C. Opportunities, Challenges and a Paradigm for Newborn Screening Refusal Dashboard in California. *In Preparation for JAMA Pediatrics.*
2. Lin, C.; **D'Apolito, G;** Matteson, J; Prediction Model of Newborn Screening Refusal Rates in California. *In Preparation for Genetics in Medicine.*

PRESENTATIONS

1. **Midwife Perspectives on Newborn Screening Processes in California: A Mixed Methods Survey** |Association of Public Health Laboratory Newborn Screening Symposium | Poster Presentation | New Orleans, LA | October 2026

2. **Legal epidemiological Policy Mapping of Newborn Screening Declination** | International Consortium of Newborn Sequencing | Poster Presentation | Boston, MA | October 2026

3. **Newborn Screening Timeliness in the Central Coast of California** | Interdisciplinary Association of Population Health Science Annual Symposium | Poster Presentation | Portland, OR | September 2026

4. **Development of Newborn Screening Refusal Dashboard**| Association of Public Health Laboratories Annual Conference | Poster Presentation | Baltimore, MD | May 2026

5. **Starting Strong: Newborn Screening Policy Analysis** |Society for Public Health Education Annual Conference | Poster Presentation | Portland, OR | April 2026

6. **Declining Newborn Screening** |Arizona State University Health Impact Summit | Poster Presentation | Phoenix, AZ | April 2026 |Oral Presentation

7. **Born into Inequity: Understanding Risk and Mortality Among Arizona's Newborns** |Arizona Health Equity Conference | Poster Presentation | Phoenix, AZ | October 2025

8. **Impacts of Genome Supplemented Newborn Screening** |Association of Public Health Laboratory Newborn Screening Symposium | Poster Presentation | Providence, RI | October 2025 | *First Place Poster Award

9. **Examining the Structural Capacity of CBOs through a Modified SWOT Analysis** | Interdisciplinary Association of Population Health Science Annual Symposium | Poster Presentation | Pittsburgh, PA | September 2025

10. **Investigating Patient Trust: Possible Increase of NBS Parent Refusals** |Arizona State University Institute for Social Science Research |Oral Presentation | Phoenix, AZ |April 2025

11. **The Potential of Genome Supplemented Newborn Screening** | California Department of Public Health Genetic Disease Screening Program | Oral Presentation | February 2025

12. **Using Lean Six Sigma Gemba Walk to Improve Patient Safety in Genetic Disease Screening** | Association of Public Health Laboratory Newborn Screening Continuous Quality Improvement Symposium | Oral Presentation | Washington, DC |April 2023

13. **Genetic Disease Screening Laboratory Reassignment for Equitable Newborn Screening in California** | California Department of Public Health Genetic Disease Screening Program | Oral Presentation Conference | Sacramento, California| March 2023

14. **Timeliness of Newborn Screening Samples in CA** |Association of Public Health Laboratory Newborn Screening Symposium | Poster Presentation |Tacoma, WA| August 2022

15. **Data Analysis in CA Newborn Screening Program** | California Department of Public Health Genetic Disease Screening Program | Oral Presentation | February 2022

16. **Implementation of a Sunday Courier Service for Newborn Screening Samples** |Association of Public Health Laboratory Newborn Screening Symposium| Oral Presentation| October 2021

17. **Overcoming Barriers in Progressive Multiple Sclerosis Care at The Ohio State University MS Center using the Donabedian Model and Optimal Interdisciplinary Care and Education**|2018 Denman Undergraduate Research Forum | Oral Presentation | Columbus, OH| April 2018

AWARDS

UCLA Travel Award
Presented by: University of California, Los Angeles Genetics Department | September 2026 | $900

APHL Intern Travel Award
Presented by: Association of Public Health Laboratories | August 2026 | $2,000

ASU Graduate College Graduate Research Support Program
Presented by: Arizona State University Graduate College | April 2026 | $2,000

Graduate College 2026-27 Travel Award
Presented by: Arizona State University Graduate College | April 2026 | $500

Outstanding Research Award
Presented by: Arizona State University Graduate Student Government | April 2026 | $750

Outstanding Mentor Award
Presented by: Arizona State University Graduate Student Government | April 2026 | $750

Graduate College 2025-26 Travel Award
Presented by: Arizona State University Graduate College | April 2026 | $500

APHL Intern Travel Award
Presented by: Association of Public Health Laboratories | April 2026 | $2,000

Professional Development Award
Presented by: Arizona State University Graduate Student Government | March 2026 | $500

Travel Award
Presented by: Arizona State University Graduate Student Government | February 2026 | $945

University Graduate Fellowship Award
Presented by: Arizona State University Graduate College | January 2026 | $1,650

Research Publication Award
Presented by: Arizona State University Graduate Student Government | November 2025 | $1,200

First Place Award - Poster Competition
Presented by: Association of Public Health Laboratories | October 2025

APHL Intern Travel Award
Presented by: Association of Public Health Laboratories | September 2025| $2,000

AZ Health Equity Conference Scholarship Award
Presented by: 2025 Arizona Health Equity Conference Planning Committee | September 2025 | $200

Graduate College 2025-26 Travel Award
Presented by: Arizona State University Graduate College | June 2025 | $500

University Graduate Fellowship Award
Presented by: Arizona State University Graduate College | January 2025 | $885

University Graduate Fellowship Award
Presented by: Arizona State University College of Health Solutions | September 2024 | $890

Serving University Needs (SUN) Award in Teaching Assistantship
Presented by: Arizona State University| July 2024

University Graduate Fellowship Award
Presented by: Arizona State University Graduate College | January 2024 | $750

Public Health Acknowledging My Efforts (PHAME) Award for Continuous Improvement
Presented by: California Department of Public Health, Office of Performance and Development |April 2023

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of California, Los Angeles Genetics Department | **Administrative Officer & Data Analyst** | September 2023 - present
- UCLA Genetic Counseling Program 2-week rotations

Arizona State University College of Health Solutions | **Teaching Assistant** | May-August 2024
- Teaching Assistant in Health Theory course
- Awarded the Serving University Needs (SUN) Award in Teaching Assistantship

Arizona State University College of Health Solutions | **Guest Lecture** | September 2025
- KIN 101- Introduction to Kinesiology
- Title: Evidence Quality and Sources to Enhance Public Trust

Arizona State University College of Health Solutions | **Guest Lecture** | October 2024
- POP615- Organizational Behavior and Theory
- Title: Learning and Attitudes in Organizational Behavior and Theory

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PROFESSIONAL ORGANIZATION MEMBERSHIP

International Consortium for Newborn Sequencing (ICoNS)
Interdisciplinary Association for Population Health Science (IAPHS)
American Association for the Advancement of Science (AAAS)
Association of Public Health Laboratories (APHL)
Maternal and Child Health Translational Research Team (MCH TRT)

WORK EXPERIENCE

September 2023 - present | *University of California, Los Angeles Genetics Department* | **Administrative Officer & Data Analyst in Newborn Screening**

January 2022 - July 2023 | *State of California Department of Public Health, Genetic Disease Screening Program* | **Public Health Data Manager**

November 2020 - December 2021 | *State of South Carolina Dept of Health Newborn Screening Program* | **Health Information Technology Coordinator**

CLINICAL EXPERIENCE

August 2019-March 2020 | *University of Pittsburgh Medical Center Presbyterian Emergency Department* | **Physician Task Facilitator**

August 2016 - December 2016 | *Ohio State University Wexner Medical Center* | **Neurology Undergraduate Intern**

SERVICE

Community Advocate Peer Mentor | ASU Graduate College **|** August 2025-Present

Poster Judge | Interdisciplinary Association of Population Health Science Annual Symposium **|** September 2026

Graduate Student Government Reviewer | August 2025-May 2026

President, Exercise and Nutrition Science and Population Health Graduate Club | August 2023-May 2026

Association of Public Health Laboratories Newborn Screening Journal Club | April 2025-Present

Ad-hoc Reviewer:
NEJM Catalyst Innovations in Care Delivery Review; Current Diabetes Reports

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GRANT HISTORY

Agency: ASU Institute for Social Science Research Seed Grant
Title: Centering Patient Voices in SMS Messaging for Chronic Disease Support and Food Insecurity
Mechanism: Pilot funding
PI: Verdecias-Pellum
Role: Graduate Research Assistant
Total Budget: $8,000
Award Period: 12/16/2025-12/15/2026

Agency: Creighton Community Foundation
Title: Designing Digital Engagement Tools for Medical Food Box & Chronic Disease Support
Mechanism: Foundation pilot grant
PI: Verdecias-Pellum
Role: Graduate Research Assistant
Total Budget: $14,992
Award Period: 12/16/2025-12/15/2026